3.0

CITY OPERATIONAL PLAN 2025–26

Implementing initiatives which support the delivery of the Council Plan 2022–2027.

Greenheart Robina Parklands

3.1 Introduction

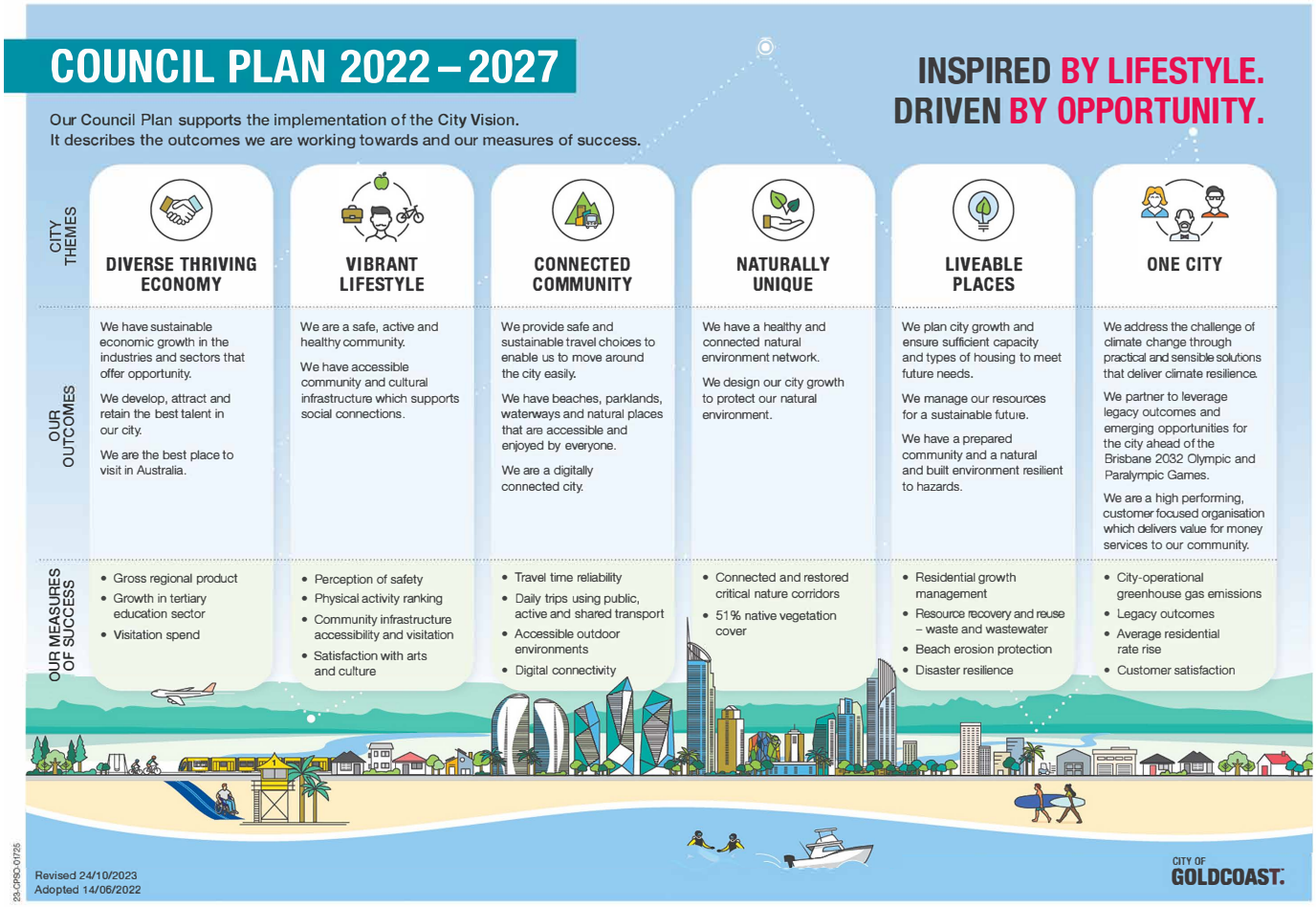
The City Vision 'Inspired by lifestyle. Driven by opportunity.' defines the longer-term aspiration for the Gold Coast and informs all strategic planning for the city. This vision is supported by six Gold Coast 2032 themes that describe our aspirations for the city through to 2032.

The Council Plan 2022-2027 and annual Operational Plan support the implementation of the City Vision.

3.2 Council Plan 2022-2027

The Council Plan 2022-2027 is structured around the six Gold Coast 2032 themes. It describes the priority outcomes the City is working towards, and our measures of success over a five-year period.

Figure 1: Council Plan 2022-2027



3.3 City Operational Plan 2025-26

The Operational Plan supports the Council Plan 2022-2027 by including Actions that need to be implemented to deliver on Council Plan themes and outcomes.

Actions are presented on the following pages by theme.

Diverse Thriving Economy

Our city has a high-performance economy, powered by talent and innovation.

Council Plan Outcomes

We have sustainable economic growth in the industries and sectors that offer opportunity.
Measure: Gross Regional Product.

We develop, attract, and retain the best talent in our city.
Measure: Growth in tertiary education sector.

We are the best place to visit in Australia.
Measure: Visitation spend.

2025-26 Actions

Fund the City's Controlled Entities to facilitate positive, collaborative economic outcomes for the City.
Design the framework that will deliver the Nature-Based Tourism Portfolio.
Develop the commercial proposal for the Springbrook Cableway as part of the Nature-Based Tourism Portfolio.
Continue to implement the Kirra Beach Tourist Park Repurchase Scheme.
Develop an Event Delivery Toolkit to support significant events being held in the City's key precincts.

City Strategies and Plans

- Economic Development International Plan 2015

Vibrant Lifestyle

Our city is welcoming, and simply the best place to visit.

Council Plan Outcomes

We are a safe, active and healthy community.
Measure: Perception of safety; Physical activity ranking.

We have accessible community and cultural infrastructure which supports social connections.
Measure: Community infrastructure accessibility and visitation; Satisfaction with arts and culture.

2025-26 Actions

Implement the 2028 Community Safety Program.
Implement the 10-year Safety Camera Network Plan.
Implement the new Local Law Framework.
Deliver the Caravan Education and Safety Program (Education and Compliance Program).
Implement the Community Services and Facilities review.
Deliver the Community Leasing Framework review.
Deliver the Accessible and Inclusive City Action Plan.
Implement the Sport and Physical Activity Strategy 2022-2032.
Implement the Youth Program 2027.
Develop a 2-year Arts and Culture Action Plan.
Develop a Recreational Water Quality Management Plan.

City Strategies and Plans

- Arts and Culture Strategy
- Accessible and Inclusive City Action Plan
- Community Safety Program 2028
- Sport and Physical Activity Strategy 2022-2032
- Youth Program 2027

Connected Community

Our City is accessible, connected and convenient, supporting our lifestyle.

Council Plan Outcomes

We provide safe and sustainable travel choices to enable us to move around the city easily.
Measure: Travel time reliability; Daily trips using public, active, and shared transport.

We have beaches, parklands, waterways, and natural places that are accessible and enjoyed by everyone.
Measure: Accessible outdoor environments.

We are a digitally connected city.
Measure: Digital connectivity.

2025-26 Actions

Continue to implement the Gold Coast Beaches Restoration Strategy to reinstate our beaches to pre-cyclone Alfred condition.
Investigate technology for Parking including cashless payments and sensor contract.
Partner with Telecommunication Providers to increase digital connectivity for City owned sites.
Implement readiness and preparedness activities for wireless communication technologies (5G/6G).

City Strategies and Plans

- Active Transport Plan 2017-2027
- City Freight Plan 2018-2028
- City Parking Plan 2031
- Gold Coast Road Safety Plan 2021-2026
- Gold Coast Transport Strategy 2031
- Our Coastal Lifestyle Strategy 2050
- Public Transport Plan 2018-2028
- Road Network Plan 2018-2028

Naturally Unique

Our City values its natural environment, that gives us a lifestyle like no other.

Council Plan Outcomes

We have a healthy and connected natural environment network.
Measure: Connected and restored critical nature corridors.

We design our city growth to protect our natural environment.
Measure: Natural Area Land Acquisitions; 51% native vegetation cover.

2025-26 Actions

Develop the Urban Forest Plan for the City.
Achieve and maintain Native Vegetation Targets.
Renew Environmental Management Plans.

City Strategies and Plans

- Gold Coast Biosecurity Plan 2025-2032
- Koala Conservation Plan
- Nature Based Recreation Plan 2015-2025
- Our Natural City Strategy 2032

Liveable Places

Our city is well-planned and designed, growing with future generations in mind.

Council Plan Outcomes

We plan city growth and ensure sufficient capacity and types of housing to meet future needs.
Measure: Residential growth management.

We manage our resources for a sustainable future.
Measure: Resource recovery and reuse – waste and wastewater.

We have a prepared community and a natural and built environment resilient to hazards.
Measure: Beach erosion protection; Disaster resilience.

2025-26 Actions

Deliver the Local Government Infrastructure Plan (LGIP3).
Deliver the new Planning Scheme Program including a Local Growth Management Strategy (LGMS).
Complete the Infrastructure Strategy and associated network modelling to inform the Local Growth Management Scheme and Planning Scheme development.
Manage the recovery and restoration of the City's infrastructure assets which were damaged by Cyclone Alfred.
Continue to implement the Albert River Sewage Spill Enforceable Undertaking and associated independent report actions.
Implement the Towards Zero Waste Plan 2025-2028.
Deliver the Yatala-Stapylton Industrial Area Expansion Investigation Project.

City Strategies and Plans

- City Plan
- Local Disaster Management Plan 2024
- Local Government Infrastructure Plan (LGIP)
- Stormwater Drainage Management Plan 2021-2031
- Towards Zero Waste Plan 2025-2028
- Water Netserv Plan - Part A

One City

Our City has strong partnerships and advocates to maximise emerging opportunities.

Council Plan Outcomes

We address the challenge of climate change through practical and sensible solutions that deliver climate resilience.

Measure: City-operational greenhouse gas emissions.

We partner to leverage legacy outcomes and emerging opportunities for the city ahead of the Brisbane 2032 Olympic and Paralympic Games.

Measure: Legacy outcomes.

We are a high performing, customer focused organisation which delivers value for money services to our community.

Measure: Average residential rate rise; Customer satisfaction.

2025-26 Actions

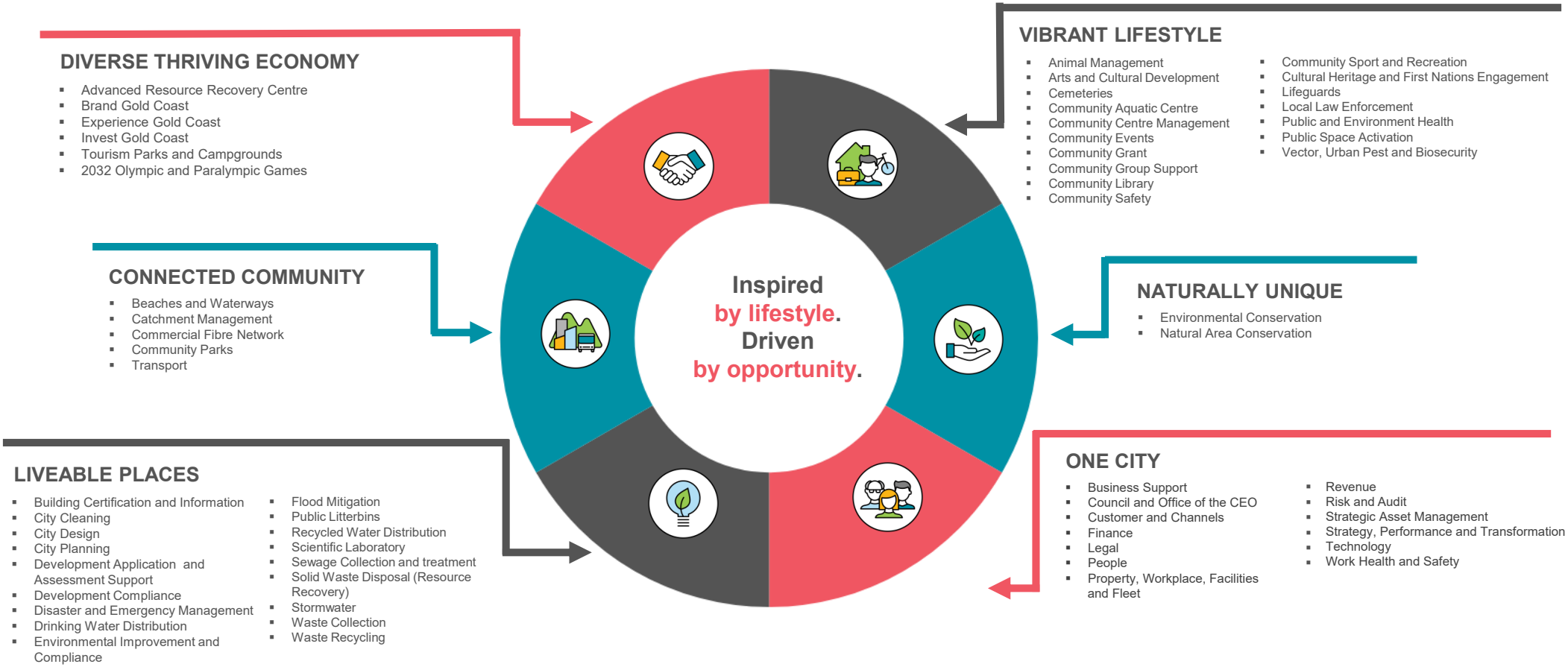
Develop a fiscally responsible budget.
Develop the City's Net Zero Emissions Plan.
Uplift our Asset Management practices ensuring resilient, fit for purpose and cost-effective infrastructure is provided and maintained for our community.
Deliver the annual capital works program.
Deliver the Voice of Customer project.
Develop and implement the Gold Coast 2032 External Business Readiness Program.
Coordinate the delivery of the Olympics 100-Day review actions to ensure alignment with City strategies.
Develop a First Nations Engagement Framework.

City Strategies and Plans

- 2032 Gold Coast Legacy Strategy
- Climate Resilience and Sustainability Strategy 2023–2033
- Customer Experience Strategy

3.4 City Services

Council provides a wide range of services to the City of Gold Coast community now and in the future.



3.5 Risk Management

Effective management of strategic and operational risks is essential to the success of the organisation. The City has adopted an Enterprise Risk Management (ERM Framework that aligns with AS/NZS ISO 31000:2018 Risk Management standards. This framework enables a structured approach to identifying, assessing, and evaluating risks across the City, ensuring appropriate controls are in place.

By fostering a proactive risk management culture, the City enhances its ability to achieve its vision and strategic objectives. This approach identifies potential threats early, strengthens resilience, and ensures that decisions are made with a clear understanding of key risks. All risk management practices are guided by the City's endorsed risk appetite, as set by Council.

The City focuses risk management and assurance efforts on areas that could have the highest impact on the community, staff or the organisation. At the operational level, risk management is embedded in the organisation's culture and is the responsibility of all staff. The Audit and Risk Committee plays a key oversight and advisory role by receiving regular reports on strategic risks and risk management activities.

3.6 Evaluation of Performance

The performance of the Operational Plan Actions will be reviewed and published in a quarterly report and an annual report (Annual Report) to Council. These provide an assessment of progress towards achieving our City Vision and Council Plan outcomes.

While a comprehensive view of performance will be available, reports are generally exception based, with a focus on areas of significant or unexpected variation from the Operational Plan.

3.7 Legislation

The Local Government Act 2009, supported by the Local Government Regulation 2012, requires Council to prepare and adopt an annual Operational Plan for each financial year which:

- progresses the implementation of the Council Plan
- explains how risks are managed
- includes the annual Performance Plan for each commercial business unit.

Progress against the Operational Plan is required to be reported to Council at regular intervals of not more than three months. Council may, by resolution, amend its annual Operational Plan at any time before the end of the financial year.

The Council Plan 2022-2027 aligns with the Queensland Plan at a local level. The Queensland Plan provides a 30-year vision for Queensland (*Queensland Plan Act 2014*).

3.8 Annual Performance Plans

The City's two commercialised business units - Gold Coast Water and Gold Coast Waste Management - deliver essential city services. Their Performance Plans are included in Chapter 4.